

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF)
Malawi Country Office**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Lilongwe, Malawi
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Innovation and Technology for Development

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Ms. Mitsuki Nishi
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Innovation Specialist

3. Background information

The UNICEF Malawi Country Programme Document (CPD)(2024-2028) works through a One-UN approach based on the new United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework (UNSCDF) Strategic Priorities. 2024-2028). All four strategic priorities of the UNSCDF 2024-2028 hold significance to UNICEF and the priorities identified for children: i) Economic Development, ii) Governance, iii) Human Capital Development, and iv) Climate Change. UNICEF co-leads the further elaboration and results in developing the Human Capital Development strategic priority. The intent of the UNICEF CPD 2024-2028 is fully aligned with these priorities, which are also directly linked to the pillars of Malawi Vision 2063, and the Malawi Implementation Plan (MIP, 2030). To this extent, UNICEF's strategy for the CPD includes Child Survival and Development (Health, Nutrition and WASH), Education, Learning and Child Protection, Social Policy (Social Protection and Public Finance for Children), Gender Equality, Inclusion and Innovation within a robust evidence-informed environment. These are focus areas under the Human Capital Development Enabler of the MIP (2030). The Country Programme envisages the progressive fulfilment of

the rights to survival, development, education, protection and participation of all children, including adolescents, especially the most vulnerable and those at risk of being left behind, in an inclusive, resilient and protective environment. All components are supported by the programme and operational effectiveness and efficiency imperatives. Risk-informed programming across the humanitarian and development nexus in all three outcome areas will strengthen disaster preparedness, enhance climate adaptation/mitigation and response, and increase the resilience capacity of institutions, communities and young people. Programming aligns with UNICEF Core Commitments for Children in Humanitarian Action and the Inter-Agency Standing Committee's Transformative Agenda.

The innovation function falls under Programme Effectiveness. As part of the CPD 2024-2028, piloting and scaling innovation and digital technology have been identified as key drivers to accelerate programme delivery and effectiveness, addressing emerging national challenges such as climate crisis. Following stakeholder consultations, the Innovation Unit has identified three key innovation portfolios to prioritize:

1. Youth and Social Innovation Portfolio
2. Technology for Development (T4D) and Digitalization Portfolio
3. Data Innovation Portfolio

Regarding the government's priorities, the Malawi Government's overarching development agenda, Vision2063, has emphasized the need for bolstering human capacity development around digital skills and innovation not only as alternative learning and socio-economic methods but as core strategies to sustain growth and resilience. In the United Nations May 2023 Policy Brief on Vision 2063, the paper cites "sustained investment in enterprise and SME development, innovation, and digital technology.

Given this background, an exciting opportunity has arisen to join the Innovation Unit to support mainstreaming Innovation and T4D into the UNICEF programming, identifying, testing, and scaling up innovative solutions for children in Malawi. Under the close supervision and guidance of the Innovation Specialist, and in close collaboration with the T4D Specialist, the Fellow will be assisting in the planning, implementation, and monitoring of key projects within one of the three innovation portfolios. The role also involves supporting the Innovation Unit in critical areas, including partnership development, resource mobilization, capacity building and knowledge management, all of which are vital to accelerating UNICEF Malawi's programme delivery for children and young people in the country.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will perform the following duties:

Innovation Programme Planning, Implementation, and Monitoring:

- Assist in the planning, reporting, and monitoring of innovation and T4D initiatives.
- Contribute to the strategic scaling of flagship innovation initiatives by compiling challenges, documenting lessons learned, and supporting evidence generation.

Innovation Knowledge Management, Sharing, and Capacity Building:

- Scan, curate, and disseminate cutting-edge innovative approaches globally to replicate and implement solutions for emerging issues in Malawi.
- Ensure the innovations knowledge base is up-to-date, including research, analysis documents, and reports.
- Capture, synthesize, and share lessons learned from innovative programming and pilot projects to enhance the country's programme learnings.
- Identify and support awareness, capacity building, and training opportunities related to Innovation and T4D.

Partnership Building and Resource Mobilization:

- Assist in analyzing Malawi's innovation ecosystem and identify potential partners, including government, private sector, entrepreneurial organizations, and academia, to strategically scale up innovations.
- Conduct proactive research on potential donors and explore innovative financing mechanisms to support sustainable scaling of innovation and digital enabled interventions.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

An advanced university degree (Master's) in business administration, information systems, product design and management, entrepreneurship, or other relevant fields is required.

Work experience

- One year of demonstrated experience in project planning, management, and monitoring, and/or research and analysis, is required.
- Experience in private sector companies, startups, or research-based innovation organizations is an advantage.

Languages

Fluency in English is required, both strong written and verbal skills.

Other skills

Specific coursework or training on Human/User Centered Design is advantageous.

Competencies

Professionalism: Demonstrates professional competence and mastery of subject matter

Teamwork: Works collaboratively with colleagues to achieve organizational goals

Communication: Speaks and write clearly and effectively.

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment, the Fellow will be able to:

- Support the innovation projects in planning, implementing, and monitoring.
- Write reports, communication materials, and resource mobilization proposals.
- Understand Malawi's and UNICEF's innovation ecosystems.

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

- The Fellow will receive initial onboarding support, briefings and trainings in UNICEF processes and mandatory training requirements.
- Development and monitoring of the fellow's work plan with the supervisor.
- Weekly and ad hoc meetings with the supervisor.
- Weekly meetings with the innovation team.

8. Living conditions in the country

General Information: Malawi, a landlocked country in East Central Africa, is renowned for its breathtaking landscapes, including the Great Rift Valley, Lake Malawi, and a diverse array of flora and fauna. It is bordered by Tanzania, Zambia, and Mozambique. The climate is predominantly tropical, featuring three distinct seasons: the cold-dry season from May to September, the hot-dry season in October and November, and the warm-wet season from December to April. Temperatures range from 14 to 32 degrees Celsius, occasionally dropping to as low as 5 degrees Celsius during the cold season. Malawi's population of around 21 million is primarily engaged in agriculture, with English and Chichewa as the

official languages. The country has a rich cultural heritage, with various ethnic groups contributing to its vibrant traditions and social fabric.

Living in Lilongwe offers a mix of urban and rural experiences. The city has several international schools, shopping centers, and recreational facilities. However, it also faces challenges such as periodic water and electricity shortages, limited healthcare facilities, and varying levels of infrastructure development. Despite these challenges, many expatriates find Lilongwe to be a welcoming and vibrant place to live, with a strong sense of community and numerous opportunities for outdoor activities and cultural experiences.

Economy: Malawi's economy is predominantly dependent on smallholder agriculture with about 90 percent of its population engaged in mixed subsistence farming. Most of the population generates very low levels of income, leading to widespread poverty. Approximately 39 percent of Malawians live below the international poverty line and, as of 2009, 15 percent were living in "ultra poor" households.

Climate: The climate in Malawi is largely categorized as tropical with three distinct seasons: the cold-dry season between May and September, the hot-dry season in October / November, and the warm-wet season between December and April. Temperatures average between 14 and 32 degrees Celsius, but can drop to as low as 5 degrees Celsius during the cold season.

Religion: Christians make up 83 percent of the population, the majority of which are Roman Catholics and Presbyterians. Anglicans, Evangelicals, Baptists, Adventists, Pentecostals and Methodists are also present in relatively small numbers. Muslims make up 13 percent of the remaining population.

Languages: There are 16 known living languages across Malawi, but Chichewa and English are the official or national languages. English is taught in schools, and many people in urban areas may speak at least basic English. Residents in most rural communities speak Chichewa and other local languages according to their ethnic identity.

Housing: The incumbent will live in Lilongwe, which has most of the economic and social amenities at a reasonable cost. Depending on living arrangements, housing can be expensive. In Malawi urban areas, house hunting is usually governed by the following four parameters: location, electricity, security and constant water supply. The approved UNDSS residential areas in Lilongwe include Area 2, Area 6, Area 9, Area 10, Area 11, Area 12, Area 14, Area 43 and Area 44. Depending on the specificity of requirements for housing, as well as the availability of either stand-alone house, or houses/townhouses in a compound, it may a little while to find appropriate housing.

Hotels: There are good hotels in Lilongwe. Prices at mid-range to up-market establishments range between \$95.00 - \$180.00 for a room.

Banks: Most of the major banks are open from 9am to 3pm from Monday to Friday and from 9:00am to 11:00am on Saturday. Standard Bank and most banks' ATMs accept major credit cards such as Visa, American Express and MasterCard, where you can withdraw cash in local currency. Most of the shops, supermarkets, hotels and restaurants accept cash and major credit cards such as Visa, American Express and MasterCard.

Communication: Mobile phone SIM cards for local service providers are also easily available from local vendors with rates for local calls much more reasonable compared to international calls. The two major mobile networks with 4G internet, are Airtel Malawi (shares the same compound with UNICEF House) and Telecom Networks Malawi.

Electricity is supplied by the Electricity Supply Corporation of Malawi. Currently it is supplied with 50 cycles AC, 220/240 volts, and a single phase. As electricity supply within Malawi is inconsistent, it would be advisable to have a generator. Domestic electrical fittings and appliances generally use the British type 13-amp fused square tree-pin plugs. It is advisable to carry an adapter and a surge protector for electrical appliances.

Transportation: Regarding transportation, it is quite easy to get around Lilongwe. There are reliable taxis drivers who can take you to and from the office.

Vaccination: Yellow fever vaccination is a requirement and proof of vaccination may be required at the airport depending on your transit countries.

Security: The general security situation in Malawi is stable; however, caution should be exercised in all activities.

Malawi, also known as “Warm Heart of Africa”, is a unique country, peaceful and friendly, and working with UNICEF Malawi is a unique opportunity to contribute towards improving the life of children and women. It provides an interesting and enriching environment, but also requires a mature level of cultural awareness, as well as more stamina and commitment than elsewhere to make life comfortable and affordable. Therefore, flexibility and the ability and willingness to live and work in harsh and potentially hazardous conditions, involving physical hardship and little comfort, are essential.